

THEME 10 · B1+/B2

Education

10A As Easy as ABC — talking about education, expressing reasons/results, body language

10B What Do You Mean? — non-verbal communication and interpreting meaning

Warm-up

Look at the title: Education. What do you think we will talk about in this theme? Tell your partner two ideas.

VOCABULARY

New words

20 target words

curriculum

n.



müfredat

The new curriculum gives students more freedom to choose their own subjects.

rote learning

n. phrase



ezbere öğrenme

Critics argue that rote learning doesn't prepare students for real-life problem solving.

student-centred

adj.



öğrenci merkezli

A student-centred classroom lets learners choose how they explore a topic.

assessment

n.



değerlendirme

Some schools rely on a single final exam, while others use continuous assessment.

motivation

n.



motivasyon

Her motivation to study medicine comes from watching her grandmother recover from illness.

self-discipline

n.



öz disiplin

Homeschooled students often need strong self-discipline to keep up with their studies.

peer pressure

n. phrase



akran baskısı

Peer pressure can push students to study harder, or to skip class altogether.

drop out

phr. v. (intransitive)



okulu/kursu bırakmak

He nearly dropped out in his final year, but a supportive teacher changed his mind.

catch up

phr. v. (transitive/intransitive)



geriyi kapatmak, yetişmek

The tutoring programme helps students catch up on material they missed.

look into

phr. v. (transitive)



araştırmak, incelemek

Before choosing a school, it's worth looking into its teaching methods.

work out

phr. v. (transitive)



çözmek, hesaplamak

The class worked out the answer together instead of being given it directly.

hand in

phr. v. (transitive)



teslim etmek

Students must hand in their portfolios by the end of the term.

body language

n. phrase



beden dili

Good interviewers read a candidate's body language as carefully as their answers.

gesture

n.



el kol hareketi, jest

She made a small gesture with her hand to show she wanted to speak.

facial expression

n. phrase



yüz ifadesi

His facial expression gave away his disappointment before he said a word.

posture

n.



duruş

Confident posture — shoulders back, chin level — can change how others see you.

eye contact

n. phrase



göz teması

In many cultures, steady eye contact signals honesty and confidence.

avoid

v.



kaçınmak

Nervous speakers often avoid eye contact with the audience.

interpret

v.



yorumlamak

It can be difficult to interpret a gesture correctly without knowing the culture behind it.

cross one's arms

v. phrase



kollarını kavuşturmak

When the teacher asked a tricky question, he crossed his arms and looked away.

Quick game · What's the word?

“yüz ifadesi”

a curriculum

b catch up

c facial expression

Quick game · What's the word?

“teslim etmek”

a work out

b rote learning

c hand in

Quick game · What's the word?

“öz disiplin”

a peer pressure

b self-discipline

c drop out

Quick game · What's the word?

“akran baskısı”

a interpret

b peer pressure

c self-discipline

Quick game · What's the word?

“kollarını kavuşturmak”

a cross one's arms

b facial expression

c rote learning

Quick game · What's the word?

“geriyi kapatmak, yetişmek”

a gesture

b catch up

c curriculum

GRAMMAR

Clauses of Reason and Result

Notice

Many families choose homeschooling **because** it lets children learn at their own pace.

Since the exam covers so much material, students often revise for weeks beforehand.

The lecture was **so** boring **that** half the class stopped taking notes.

The school introduced **such** a flexible timetable **that** attendance improved almost overnight.

In which sentences does the underlined word introduce a REASON (why something happens), and in which introduces a RESULT (what happens because of it)?

Complete the rule

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

a reason

a result

so/such...that

because/since/as/due to

Complete the rule

_____ are used to introduce _____.

✓ **because/since/as/due to / a reason**

Complete the rule

_____ structures are used to introduce _____.

✓ **so/such...that / a result**

The rule

Reason connectors (because, since, as, due to) explain WHY something happens. 'So + adjective/adverb + that' and 'such + (a/an) + adjective + noun + that' structures describe the RESULT of something. 'Due to' is followed by a noun/noun phrase (due to low attendance), while the others are followed by a clause.

TR Sebep bildiren bağlaçlar (because, since, as, due to) bir olayın NEDENİNİ açıklar. 'So + sıfat/zarf + that' ve 'such + (a/an) + sıfat + isim + that' yapıları ise bir olayın SONUCUNU bildirir. 'Due to' isim/isim öbeğiyle kullanılır (due to low attendance), diğerleri bir cümle alır.

When? We use because/since/as/due to to explain the reason behind an educational choice or outcome; we use so...that/such...that to show how intense something was and what result it led to.

TR Bir eğitim tercihinin ya da başarının nedenini açıklarken because/since/as/due to; bir durumun ne kadar yoğun olduğunu ve bunun ne gibi bir sonuca yol açtığını anlatırken so...that/such...that kullanırız.

Build sentences · Example

she

+

chose / online learning

+

because / it fit her work schedule

She chose online learning because it fit her work schedule.

Build sentences

many students + prefer / group projects +

since / they learn from each other

Many students prefer group projects since they learn from each other.

Build sentences

the school + changed the timetable + due to / low attendance on Fridays

The school changed the timetable due to low attendance on Fridays.

Build sentences

the test

+

was / so difficult

+

that / almost nobody finished it

The test was so difficult that almost nobody finished it.

Build sentences

it + **was / such a useful workshop** + **that / the school repeated it twice**

It was such a useful workshop that the school repeated it twice.

Build sentences

? / you

+

choose this school

+

as / it offers more electives

Did you choose this school as it offers more electives?

Your turn

Write four sentences explaining reasons and results connected to your own education — why you chose something, or what a result of your effort was.

I chose... because...

Since..., I decided to...

The class was so... that...

It was such a... that...

Form

POSITIVE

She switched schools because the new one offered better labs.

The course was so intensive that students needed extra breaks.

NEGATIVE

He didn't drop out, even though the material was difficult.

It wasn't such a hard exam that everyone failed.

QUESTION

Why did you choose this programme?

Was the workshop so useful that you'd recommend it?

SHORT ANSWERS

Because it matched my interests.

Yes, it was. / No, not really.

Error detective

She chose this school due to it has smaller classes.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ She chose this school due to its smaller classes. / She chose this school because it has smaller classes.

Error detective

The lesson was so interesting lesson that nobody left early.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **The lesson was so interesting that nobody left early.**

Error detective

It was such interesting lesson that we asked for more.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **It was such an interesting lesson that we asked for more.**

A • Choose the correct option.

The school closed early _____ the heavy snow.

a due to

b so that

c such that

A • Choose the correct option.

The topic was _____ complicated that the teacher explained it twice.

a such

b so

c due to

A • Choose the correct option.

It was _____ demanding course that three students dropped out.

a so

b such a

c due to

B · Complete with the correct connector.

_____ she missed so many classes, she had to catch up over the summer.

✓ **Since / As / Because**

B · Complete with the correct connector.

The exam results improved _____ the new tutoring programme.

✓ **due to**

B · Complete with the correct connector.

The lecture hall was _____ full that some students had to stand.

✓ so

C · Judge the sentence.

He failed the test due to he didn't revise.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ He failed the test because he didn't revise. / He failed the test due to a lack of revision.

C · Judge the sentence.

It was such a clear explanation that everyone understood immediately.

a Correct

b Incorrect

C · Judge the sentence.

The workshop was so popular workshop that they added a second date.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **The workshop was so popular that they added a second date.**

Dialogue · Complete with the correct connector.

A: _____ you loved robotics, why didn't you choose that programme?

✓ Since / As / Because

Dialogue · Complete with the correct connector.

B: Mainly _____ it has a strong engineering programme, but also _____ my sister studied there.

✓ **because / since**

Dialogue · Reorder the sentence.

difficult / the / so / course / that / was / postponed / it / many / students

it

course

postponed

was

the

many

students

difficult

so

that

•

✓ The course was so difficult that many students postponed it.

GRAMMAR

Present Tense for General Truths + Modal Verbs of Deduction (Body Language)

Notice

Crossed arms often **signal** that a person feels defensive or uncomfortable.

She's avoiding eye contact, so she **might be** nervous about the interview.

He **must be** confident — look at that relaxed posture and steady eye contact.

They **can't be** telling the truth; their facial expressions don't match their words at all.

Which sentence states a general truth about body language, and which sentences make a GUESS about someone's feelings based on evidence?

Complete the rule

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

a general truth

a strong positive guess

a weak/possible guess

a strong negative guess (impossible)

Complete the rule

The Present Simple is used to state _____ about what body language usually means.

✓ a general truth

Complete the rule

'Might/could be' expresses _____.

✓ a weak/possible guess

Complete the rule

'Must be' expresses _____ based on strong evidence.

✓ a strong positive guess

Complete the rule

'Can't be' expresses _____ — the evidence shows it's very unlikely.

✓ a strong negative guess (impossible)

The rule

Use the Present Simple to state the general meaning of body language (Crossed arms often signal discomfort). Use modal verbs to guess how someone feels based on evidence: 'might/could be' (weak possibility), 'must be' (strong positive guess), 'can't be' (strong negative guess/impossible).

TR Beden dilinin genel anlamını açıklarken Present Simple kullanılır (Crossed arms often signal discomfort). Birinin ne hissettiğini KANITA dayanarak tahmin ederken modal fiiller kullanılır: 'might/could be' (zayıf ihtimal), 'must be' (güçlü olumlu tahmin), 'can't be' (güçlü olumsuz tahmin/imkânsız).

When? We use the Present Simple to state a general rule about body language, and modal verbs of deduction to guess how a specific person is feeling right now, based on evidence.

TR Beden dilinin genel kuralını anlatırken Present Simple; belirli bir kişinin o an ne hissettiğini kanıta dayanarak tahmin ederken modal fiilleri kullanınız.

Build sentences · Example

crossed arms

+

often / signal

+

discomfort

Crossed arms often signal discomfort.

Build sentences

he

+

avoid / eye contact

+

he / might be / shy

He's avoiding eye contact, so he might be shy.

Build sentences

she

+

smile / and / lean forward

+

she / must be / interested

She's smiling and leaning forward, so she must be interested.

Build sentences

his voice / shake

+

he

+

can't be / as calm as he claims

His voice is shaking, so he can't be as calm as he claims.

Build sentences

a firm handshake

+

usually / suggest

+

confidence

A firm handshake usually suggests confidence.

Build sentences

? / that gesture

+

mean

+

agreement / or / confusion

Could that gesture mean agreement or confusion?

Your turn

Describe a person's body language in a situation you imagine (an interview, a presentation, a first date) and write four sentences interpreting what it might mean.

Her posture suggests...

He might be... because...

That must mean...

They can't be... since...

Form

POSITIVE

Steady eye contact usually suggests honesty.

She must be excited — she can't stop smiling.

NEGATIVE

Crossed arms don't always mean someone is angry.

He can't be relaxed; his shoulders are so tense.

QUESTION

What does a raised eyebrow usually mean?

Could that gesture mean something different in another culture?

SHORT ANSWERS

It usually means surprise or doubt.

Yes, it could. / No, it can't.

Error detective

She must being nervous because she's biting her nails.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **She must be nervous because she's biting her nails.**

Error detective

He can't be interested, he's smiling and leaning forward.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ He can't be uninterested — he's smiling and leaning forward. / He must be interested, since he's smiling and leaning forward.

Error detective

Crossed arms is signalling discomfort in general.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Crossed arms generally signal discomfort.**

A • Choose the correct option.

Look at his tense shoulders and shaking hands — he _____ be extremely nervous.

a must

b can't

c signals

A • Choose the correct option.

A relaxed posture generally _____ comfort and confidence.

a is suggesting

b suggests

c must suggest

A • Choose the correct option.

She's laughing and making eye contact, so she _____ be bored.

a must

b can't

c might

B · Complete with the correct form.

A raised eyebrow often _____ (signal) surprise or doubt.

✓ signals

B · Complete with the correct form.

He avoided eye contact throughout the interview, so he
_____ (might / be) uncomfortable with the question.

✓ might be

B · Complete with the correct form.

They _____ (can't / be) telling the truth — their body language completely contradicts their words.

✓ **can't be**

C · Judge the sentence.

Crossed arms is always meaning anger.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Crossed arms don't always mean anger.**

C · Judge the sentence.

She's smiling and leaning in, so she must be enjoying the conversation.

a Correct

b Incorrect

C · Judge the sentence.

He can't nervous, his hands are shaking so much.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **He can't be calm, his hands are shaking so much.**

Dialogue · Complete with the correct modal form.

A: Look at her — she keeps checking her watch and avoiding eye contact. What _____ that mean?

✓ could / might

Dialogue · Complete with the correct modal form.

B: She _____ (must / be) worried about being late for something else.

✓ **must be**

Dialogue · Reorder the sentence.

confidence / firm / a / handshake / usually / suggests

firm

a

handshake

suggests

confidence

usually

•

✓ **A firm handshake usually suggests confidence.**

READING

One Size Doesn't Fit All

Before you read

1. Look at the title. What do you think 'one size doesn't fit all' means about education?
2. Which do you think you'd prefer as a student: a strict, exam-focused school or a flexible, student-centred one? Why?

ONE SIZE DOESN'T FIT ALL · 1 / 3

Walk into a classroom in one country and you might see rows of silent students copying notes from a board. Walk into a classroom elsewhere, and you might find children sitting in a circle, designing their own project for the week. Neither approach is automatically wrong; each simply grew out of different beliefs about how learning works best.

ONE SIZE DOESN'T FIT ALL · 2 / 3

Traditional, exam-focused systems often exist because they can be measured easily and applied to large numbers of students at once. Since a single national test can be marked quickly and compared fairly, many governments rely on it, even though critics argue it encourages rote learning rather than real understanding. Such systems can be so exam-driven that students learn to answer questions without ever asking their own.

ONE SIZE DOESN'T FIT ALL · 3 / 3

Student-centred methods, on the other hand, grew popular due to research suggesting that motivation and self-discipline improve when learners have real choices. A student who picks their own topic is often so engaged that they keep researching long after the lesson ends. The challenge is that this approach demands well-trained teachers and smaller classes — resources not every school can afford.

While you read

What is the main idea of the text?

a

Traditional education is always better than student-centred education.

b

Different education systems grew out of different beliefs and goals, each with strengths and challenges.

c

Exams should be removed from every education system.

While you read

Traditional, exam-focused systems are popular partly because they can be _____ easily.

✓ **measured**

While you read

According to the text, why do student-centred methods appeal to some educators?

a They are cheaper to run than traditional schools.

b Research suggests motivation and self-discipline improve when learners have real choices.

c They remove the need for teachers altogether.

While you read

According to the text, student-centred methods need no special resources.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to the text, student-centred methods demand well-trained teachers and smaller classes.

While you read

Critics argue that heavily exam-driven systems encourage _____ learning rather than real understanding.

✓ **rote**

After you read

1. Do you think your own school leans more toward the traditional or the student-centred approach?
2. Can you think of a downside of student-centred learning that the text doesn't mention?

READING

The Conversation Nobody Speaks

Before you read

1. What do you think the title 'The Conversation Nobody Speaks' refers to?
2. Can you think of a gesture that means different things in different cultures?

THE CONVERSATION NOBODY SPEAKS · 1 / 3

Long before a person finishes a sentence, their body has usually already said something. Researchers who study communication estimate that a large share of meaning in face-to-face conversation comes not from words, but from posture, gesture and facial expression. This silent layer of communication can support what someone says — or quietly contradict it.

THE CONVERSATION NOBODY SPEAKS · 2 / 3

Some signals appear to be almost universal. A genuine smile, for example, tends to involve the muscles around the eyes as well as the mouth, which is why a forced smile can look slightly 'off' even to a stranger. Other signals, however, change enormously between cultures. Direct eye contact might suggest confidence and honesty in one country, while in another it can be read as rude or challenging.

THE CONVERSATION NOBODY SPEAKS · 3 / 3

This is exactly why body language must be interpreted carefully, never in isolation. A single crossed-arm gesture doesn't automatically mean someone is angry or closed off; they might simply be cold, or comfortable standing that way. Skilled observers look for clusters of signals and consider the context before drawing any conclusion about what a person really means.

While you read

What is the main idea of the text?

a

Body language always means exactly the same thing everywhere.

b

A large part of communication is non-verbal, but it must be interpreted carefully and in context.

c

Facial expressions are less important than words.

While you read

A genuine smile usually involves the muscles around the eyes as well as the _____.

✓ **mouth**

While you read

According to the text, how does eye contact differ across cultures?

a It always means the same thing everywhere.

b It can suggest confidence in one culture and rudeness in another.

c It is never used outside Western countries.

While you read

According to the text, a single gesture is always enough to know exactly how someone feels.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to the text, skilled observers look for clusters of signals and context, not a single gesture.

While you read

The text says crossed arms don't automatically mean anger — a person might simply be _____.

✓ **cold**

After you read

1. Why do you think a forced smile can look 'off' to other people?
2. Do you agree that a single gesture is never enough to judge how someone feels? Why or why not?

LISTENING

Why That University?

Before you listen

1. Predict: what reasons do you think Emre will give for his choice?

Why That University?

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

While you listen

What is the main reason Emre first gives for choosing the programme?

a It is close to home.

b It has a strong reputation in robotics.

c It is the cheapest option.

While you listen

Emre says the university is close to home, so he can _____ instead of paying for accommodation.

✓ commute

While you listen

According to the dialogue, Emre chose the university for only one reason.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to the dialogue, Emre gives several reasons: reputation, location, and the scholarship.

While you listen

How does Emre feel about starting the programme?

a

More excited than nervous.

b

Completely calm, with no nerves at all.

c

Regretful about his choice.

LISTENING

Reading the Room

Before you listen

1. What do you predict this talk will focus on: what to say, or what not to say with your body?

Reading the Room

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

While you listen

What is the main topic of Ms. Kaya's talk?

a How to answer
interview questions
perfectly

b How to read and use
body language in an
interview

c How to write a good CV

While you listen

According to Ms. Kaya, slouching can suggest a lack of _____

•

✓ confidence

While you listen

According to Ms. Kaya, crossed arms always mean the interviewer is unfriendly.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to Ms. Kaya, crossed arms don't always mean unfriendliness — the person could simply be cold.

While you listen

What does Ms. Kaya say about a genuine smile?

a

It only involves the mouth.

b

It involves the whole face, so it's hard to fake.

c

It is not important in interviews.

SPEAKING

Why I'd Choose It

In pairs, discuss which education system or learning method you would choose if you could design your own school, and why. Use reason and result connectors (because, since, as, due to, so...that, such...that) as you explain your choices.

SPEAKING

What's the Body Saying?

In pairs, take turns acting out a short scene (a job interview, a first day at a new school, a disagreement between friends) using only body language for 30 seconds, while your partner guesses what you might be feeling. Then discuss your interpretations using modal verbs of deduction.

WRITING

My Ideal Way to Learn

Write a short opinion essay about which education method or system you think works best, and why. Start with a clear topic sentence, add at least three supporting sentences using reason/result connectors, and finish with a concluding sentence.

WRITING

Reading a Photograph

Choose (or imagine) a photograph of two or three people interacting. Describe their body language in detail and interpret what you think each person might be feeling, using modal verbs of deduction.

REVIEW

Exit ticket

Exit ticket

She stayed up late revising _____ the exam was the next morning.

a because

b so that

c such that

Exit ticket

The lecture was _____ interesting that nobody checked their phones.

a such

b so

c due to

Exit ticket

The trip was cancelled _____ (due to) a lack of interest.

✓ due to

Exit ticket

It was _____ a difficult question that even the teacher paused before answering.

✓ **such**

Exit ticket

He's avoiding eye contact and fidgeting, so he _____ be nervous.

a must

b can't

c signals

Exit ticket

A relaxed posture is always meaning boredom.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **A relaxed posture doesn't always mean boredom.**

Exit ticket

Crossed arms _____ (signal) discomfort, but not always.

✓ signal

Exit ticket

Which word means 'learning by repeating information without fully understanding it'?

a rote learning

b assessment

c motivation

Exit ticket

A person who leaves school before finishing is said to _____
_____ .

✓ drop out

Exit ticket

Put the words in order.

the

students

course

difficult

was

postponed

many

so

that

it

•

✓ **The course was so difficult that many students postponed it.**

Exit ticket

He failed due to he didn't revise enough.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **He failed because he didn't revise enough.**

Exit ticket

Rewrite using 'must be'.

(She's smiling and making eye contact. (probably feeling confident))

✓ **She must be feeling confident.**

Exit ticket

They _____ (can't / be) telling the truth — their expressions don't match their words.

✓ can't be

Exit ticket

Good _____ means looking directly into someone's eyes while you speak.

✓ eye contact